

DINNER · POPPY'S KITCHEN

Turkey & Black Bean Cottage Cheese Bake

A layered Tex-Mex tortilla bake where cottage cheese melts in for protein and creaminess.

4, plus a lunch SERVES	**50 min** START TO TABLE
15 min PREP	**35 min** COOK

Weeknight, mostly hands-off

🛒 What you need

FROM THE STORE

- ☐ **1¼ lb** Ground turkey 94%
- ☐ **1 can** Bush's black beans, drained and rinsed
- ☐ **1½ cups** Cottage cheese
- ☐ **1 cup** Chunky salsa, mild
- ☐ **1 packet** Taco seasoning
- ☐ **1 cup** Frozen corn
- ☐ **1** Onion, diced
- ☐ **8** Mission soft taco tortillas
- ☐ **2 cups** Mexican blend shredded cheese
- ☐ **to serve** Sour cream

FROM THE PANTRY

- ☐ **1 Tbsp** Olive oil
- ☐ **⅓ cup** Water

⚡ **First:** Oven on to 375°F.

GEAR

9×13 baking dish · Big skillet · Foil

🔥 Let's cook

1. Heat the oven to 375°F. Grease a 9×13 dish.
2. Cook the onion in the oil over medium-high, 3 minutes. Add the turkey, press flat and let it brown before breaking it up. ⏱️ 8 min
3. Stir in the taco seasoning, water, beans, corn and half the salsa. Simmer 3 minutes. ⏱️ 3 min
4. In a bowl mix the cottage cheese, the rest of the salsa and 1 cup of the cheese. 🧒 Kids can do this
5. Layer: 4 tortillas (tear to fit), half the meat, all the cottage cheese mix, 4 more tortillas, the rest of the meat. 🧒 Kids can do this
6. Top with the last cup of cheese. Cover with foil and bake 20 minutes, then uncover 10 more until bubbly. ⏱️ 30 min
7. Rest 5 minutes before cutting so the squares hold. Sour cream on top.



CHEF'S SECRET

Season the cottage cheese layer with salsa and cheese: plain cottage cheese tastes flat, but mixed this way it bakes into a creamy, cheesy middle nobody picks out.

Poppy's draft. Change something? Tell Poppy with 💡 so the card learns.



DINNER · FLIP SIDE

Turkey & Black Bean Cottage Cheese Bake

👩‍🍳 Kitchen crew: kid jobs

- [ ] Stir the cottage cheese, salsa and cheese together
- [ ] Sprinkle the cheese on top
- [ ] Tear tortillas and build the layers
- [ ] Set the table and put out sour cream and salsa

Knives, the stove and the oven: a grown-up stays right there. Steps marked 🧒 **Kids can do this** on the front are theirs to own.

⏰ MAKE IT AHEAD

Assemble up to a day ahead, cover and fridge; add 10 minutes covered.

🥡 LEFTOVERS

Squares reheat great for lunch (microwave 90 seconds or 350°F for 15).

🔁 SWAP IT

- Ground beef instead of turkey
- Pepper jack on top for heat

🍽️ SERVE IT WITH

Shredded lettuce with lime, or Alexia street corn

📝 How'd it go tonight?

😍 Love it 🙂 Like it 😐 It's OK 👎 Not for me

Date _____ Cooked by _____

Helpers _____ Next time _____

Notes and tweaks (snap a photo and send it to Poppy with 💡)

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